

# qAI37 TEAM BIOS

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**This is an execution team that has shipped the infrastructure being replaced. Platform and systems software at Microsoft, Intel, ARM, Apple, and Google at hyperscale. Quantum science led by the former Head of Algorithms at Pasqal. Built on peer-reviewed university research from Caltech and Harvard groups.**

## Core Team

### Ted Stockwell — Founder & CEO

Former General Manager of Microsoft's Online Services Division. Created Bing as a Platform, transforming search into a programmable infrastructure layer across Microsoft. Ted has spent his career turning hard infrastructure problems into platform businesses at hyperscale — that is exactly the commercial motion qAI37 needs to execute.

Bing as a Platform was not a search product. It was a decision to take a proprietary capability and open it as programmable infrastructure — the same architectural instinct that defines the HAL. Ted has spent his career at the moment when infrastructure transitions from siloed technology to platform business. That is the moment qAI37 is in.

**Prior roles:** General Manager, Microsoft Online Services Division; senior leadership across Microsoft's platform and infrastructure businesses

**qAI37 role:** Founder, CEO, and lead commercial and strategic executive. Primary relationship owner for hyperscaler and institutional investor conversations

### Michelle Holtmann — President & Chief Strategy Officer

Michelle started her career as a software engineer at Boeing writing software for commercial aircraft systems, then spent 25 years at Microsoft doing the work, designing and building infrastructure products that hundreds of millions of people depend on every day. She designed and wrote the technical specifications for Windows Genuine Advantage and its successor the Software Protection Platform, the Genuine Windows validation system now running on 1.6 billion active devices. She designed and wrote the original technical specification for the Breach Removal Tool, which grew into Windows Defender. She led Microsoft Loop from inception through commercial launch, directing 400+ engineers and product managers; Loop is now a core component of Microsoft 365 Copilot. Known for a truth-teller approach to engineering: define the acceptance criteria before you start building, and hold to them.

As a founding member of qAI37, she joined after considerable time stress-testing whether the HAL was actually buildable. She believes it is, and she designed the PP0 roadmap to prove it.

**Prior roles:** General Manager and multi-discipline program leader, Microsoft

**qAI37 role:** President and Chief Strategy Officer. Architect of the PPO validation plan. Leads investor relations, strategic partnerships, and cross-discipline program execution

### **Vicki Mitchell — Chief Engineering Officer**

Former VP of Engineering at Google, ARM, and Altera, where she led large-scale silicon, systems, and infrastructure engineering programs across global organizations. Featured in the inaugural Top 100 List of senior women leaders in engineering, prepared by Inclusive Boards in conjunction with the Financial Times. Vicki has spent her career at the intersection of hardware and software — the precise boundary the HAL is built to manage.

The HAL is fundamentally a hardware-software co-design problem: the translation layer must understand both the AI workload above it and the quantum hardware below it. Vicki has operated at that boundary throughout her career — at ARM designing the instruction sets that sit between software and silicon, at Altera building programmable hardware that software configures at runtime, and at Google scaling infrastructure engineering across the full stack. That combination is rare and directly load-bearing for the HAL build.

**Prior roles:** VP Engineering, Google; VP Engineering, ARM; VP Engineering, Altera (Intel); VP Engineering, Intel

**qAI37 role:** Chief Engineering Officer. Leads the HAL engineering program, hardware integration strategy, and global engineering team build-out

### **Steve Jahnke — CTO / Principal Architect**

30 years at Intel, Altera, and TI building processor architecture and systems software engineered to never go down. Holds 24 patents across heterogeneous computing, SoC design, and embedded systems. The translation layer problem qAI37 is solving is the same class of problem Steve has spent his career solving in silicon.

Steve's 24 patents are not in quantum computing — they are in heterogeneous computing: the problem of making software run correctly and efficiently across fundamentally different hardware substrates. That is precisely what the HAL does. His Intel, Altera, and TI methodology — build and validate on emulators in parallel with hardware development, so that by the time hardware is available the software is already proven — is the exact methodology qAI37 uses for PPO and the hardware-validation milestone.

**Prior roles:** Principal Architect and engineering leadership, Intel (30 years); engineering leadership, Altera

**Patents:** 24 patents in heterogeneous computing, SoC design, system architecture, and advanced compute pipelines

**qAI37 role:** CTO and Principal Architect. PP0 Component 2 owner: Translation Layer and HAL Stub. Owns the technical architecture of the full HAL program

### **Vincent E. Elfving — Chief Quantum Advisor**

Former Head of Algorithms at Pasqal, where he led a team of over 40 researchers developing AI workflows for neutral atom hardware. Google Quantum AI alumnus. Co-founder of Qu & Co (merged with Pasqal). PhD in Quantum Information Processing. Vincent is the reason the science behind the HAL is right — he has spent his career at the boundary of quantum algorithms and real-world workloads.

Vincent's combination is unusual and directly relevant: he is both a quantum algorithms researcher with peer-reviewed publications and an operator who has run a team translating quantum theory into production workloads for commercial hardware. His time at Pasqal means he has worked with the exact hardware vendors the HAL targets. His PhD in Quantum Information Processing means he understands the mathematical foundations of the  $O(n)$  scaling advantage at the level required to defend it in front of a technical diligence team.

**Prior roles:** Head of Algorithms, Pasqal (40+ researchers); Co-Founder/CTO, Qu & Co (merged with Pasqal); Google Quantum AI

**Education:** PhD, Quantum Information Processing

**qAI37 role:** Chief Quantum Advisor. PP0 Component 1 owner: Operation Mapping Table. Owns the quantum science foundation of the translation layer and the vendor integration strategy

### **Laverne Masaki — Chief People Officer**

Former executive recruiter at Microsoft and Google, specializing in building senior technical teams for complex, high-stakes programs. At a company whose execution depends entirely on assembling the right people at the right moment, Laverne's network and judgment are a core operational asset.

The funded engineering build reaches an approximately 50-engineer team by Month 18, hired in cohorts against the milestone gates. The candidate profile — engineers who understand PyTorch and TensorFlow at the infrastructure level and can be productive on an emulator within weeks — exists in the networks Laverne built across two decades at Microsoft and Google. Recruiting risk at this ramp is real; Laverne is the reason it is manageable.

**Prior roles:** Executive recruiter, Microsoft; executive recruiter, Google; specialization in senior technical and leadership hiring for complex engineering programs

**qAI37 role:** Chief People Officer. Leads recruiting strategy, executive search, and organizational build-out across the program

*The next critical hire — the full-time quantum lead — is signed and joins full-time approximately month ten post-close; advisory depth covers the workstream until then.*

## Extended Team

### Rupesh Srivastava — Quantum Advisor

PhD in Physics, Royal Holloway, University of London. Five years developing the UK quantum-computing ecosystem at Oxford's Department of Physics (the NQIT and QCS national quantum technology hubs, 2016–2021). Chief Quantum Officer, Entangled Positions.

### Gregor Barry — Advisor

Managing Director, Accenture, Toronto — twelve years in enterprise relationships with Fortune 500 clients.

### Rick Jahnke — Principal Engineer

30+ years embedded systems engineering; Director of Engineering, Galixsys Networks; named inventor on embedded network patents.

### Ruben Marroquin — Senior Engineer

FPGA/embedded systems engineer, Intel and Altera; patent strategy and hardware applications engineering; BS EE, Rice University.

### PP0 Engineering Ownership

Proof Point Zero — the first funded milestone of the program — has named engineering ownership. This is not a team that will figure out who builds what after funding closes.

| Component                                 | Owner                                     | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Component 1: Operation Mapping Table      | Vincent E. Elfving, Chief Quantum Advisor | Maps the mathematical operations of the target AI workload to their corresponding neutral atom hardware instructions. The reference document the translation layer is built from. Draws directly on Vincent's expertise as a quantum algorithms researcher and former Head of Algorithms at Pasqal. |
| Component 2: Translation Layer & HAL Stub | Steve Jahnke, CTO / Principal Architect   | Builds the classical software pipeline that demonstrates the HAL working. A real AI workload goes in, the translation layer intercepts its                                                                                                                                                          |

|                                               |                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                               |                                    | computational operations using Vincent's mapping table, quantum-compatible instructions come out, and the output is routed to at least two vendor formats on demand.                                                                   |
| Component 3: Investor Narrative & Walkthrough | Michelle Holtmann, President & CSO | Reviews the pipeline output, determines what is most valuable to demonstrate, and builds the narrative and walkthrough script that connects what is on screen to the business thesis. Grounded in what the pipeline actually produces. |

## Strategic Advisory Board

### Sethu Raman — Technical Advisor

Former Distinguished Engineer at both Apple and Microsoft — one of the most senior individual contributor titles in the industry, held at two of the most technically demanding organizations in the world. Following an independent technical diligence exercise — unpaid, with no equity at evaluation — Sethu assessed the HAL as an unmet market need and subsequently formalized as Technical Advisor. He is available for direct conversation with prospective investors.

**Prior roles:** Distinguished Engineer, Apple; Distinguished Engineer, Microsoft

**qAI37 role:** Technical Advisor. Independent technical evaluator (Jan–Mar 2026). Available for investor diligence conversations

### Robbie Bach — Strategic Advisor

Former President of Microsoft's Entertainment & Devices Division, where he led Xbox, Windows Mobile, Zune, and Surface. One of the most senior product and commercial executives in Microsoft's history. Deep experience in taking hardware-software platform products from inception to global scale.

**Prior roles:** President, Entertainment & Devices Division, Microsoft

### Chris Phillips — Strategic Advisor

Global technology strategist. Former Senior Vice President, Server & Tools, Microsoft. Deep experience in enterprise platform businesses and infrastructure product strategy.

**Prior roles:** SVP, Server & Tools, Microsoft

**Bill Laing — Strategic Advisor**

Technical lead for large-scale systems. Former Corporate Vice President, Windows Server & Azure, Microsoft. Decades of experience building and operating hyperscale server and cloud infrastructure.

**Prior roles:** CVP, Windows Server & Azure, Microsoft

**Darren Huston — Strategic Advisor**

Former CEO of Booking.com and former President of Microsoft Japan. Deep experience in enterprise-scale platform operations and global commercial leadership.

**Prior roles:** CEO, Booking.com; President, Microsoft Japan

**Steve Guggenheimer — Strategic Advisor**

Former Corporate Vice President, Developer Platform, Microsoft. Deep experience in developer ecosystems and platform adoption — the motion that makes an access layer canonical.

**Prior roles:** CVP, Developer Platform, Microsoft

**John Williams — Strategic Advisor**

Former architect and executive at AMD, Cray, Microsoft, and Google. Extensive experience in high-performance computing, cloud infrastructure, and strategic technology planning. Advisor to multiple deep-tech companies on compute strategy, system architecture, and long-term platform evolution.

**Prior roles:** Senior architect and executive, AMD, Cray, Microsoft, and Google

**qAI37 role:** Strategic Advisor. Provides strategic guidance on compute platform positioning, hyperscaler relationships, and long-term architecture decisions

**Luke Minford — IP & Legal Advisor**

CEO of Rouse UK, co-leading one of the world's largest specialist IP practices. Provides strategic guidance on patent portfolio development, IP commercialization, and global IP strategy.

**Prior roles:** CEO, Rouse UK

**qAI37 role:** IP & Legal Advisor. Guides patent portfolio development and commercialization strategy

**Shawn Bohnert — Board Member**

Early investor and SAFE mechanics advisor. Board member.

**qAI37 role:** Board member. Early investor and governance advisor

**Scientific Foundation**

qAI37 is built on published, peer-reviewed research: the CRNN and k-HRNN architectures (Anschuetz et al., PRX Quantum 4, 020338, 2023; Anschuetz & Gao, "Arbitrary Polynomial Separations in Trainable Quantum Machine Learning," Quantum 10, 1976 (2026), 2024), which establish that quantum neural

networks achieve arbitrary polynomial memory separations over all classical neural network architectures for autoregressive sequence tasks, and the measured neutral-atom substrate (Manetsch et al., Nature 2025). The papers are public and independently inspectable, and their authors are independently reachable through normal academic channels — a diligence feature of building on open science. qAI37's proprietary work is the commercial implementation layer above that foundation.

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